

Product Specification: "Choose Your Preview" Waitlist Experience

Project: Mapping With Melanin

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1. Overview

The "Choose Your Preview" personalized waitlist experience transforms the Mapping With Melanin pre-launch phase from a passive form submission into an active, gamified growth engine. This spec outlines the end-to-end post-signup journey, turning waitlist members into active recruiters to build critical mass for the city-by-city launch strategy, which begins in Charlotte on August 15.

The primary goals of this initiative are to unify the main website (mappingwithmelanin.com) and the </preview> experience into a single cohesive entry point, and to provide a personalized post-signup journey based on the user's track selection. By implementing a referral system and leaderboard, the platform will drive viral growth and city-based competition. Furthermore, this approach captures critical pre-launch data, such as safety concerns, claimed businesses, and ambassador niches, to populate the platform before day one.

2. Unifying the Entry Points

To create a seamless user journey, we will implement Option B: adding a prominent "Choose Your Experience" Call-to-Action (CTA) on the main website homepage that links directly to the </preview> page. This approach is the least disruptive, preserves existing SEO, and provides a clear, actionable path for users without requiring a complete homepage redesign.

3. The Unified User Flow

The user journey begins when they click the "Choose Your Experience" CTA on the main website and are routed to the </preview> page. Here, they select one of five tracks: Safety, Find Business, Own Business, Community, or Cultural Ambassador. Upon selection, the user views the animated preview corresponding to their chosen track, and these existing animations must remain unchanged.

After viewing the preview, the user completes the waitlist form, which captures their Name, Email, City, and Track. The existing form logic for capturing Name and Email must be preserved. Upon submission, the user is redirected to a newly designed, personalized

confirmation page based on their track. This confirmation page presents immediate actions, such as referrals, data contribution, and sharing, along with their unique referral link. Users can also view city and individual leaderboards to track launch progress.

4. Track-Specific Post-Signup Experiences

The post-signup experience is tailored to the user's selected track, providing relevant messaging, actions, and status updates to encourage immediate engagement.

Track	Headline	Immediate Actions	Status Display
Community Member	"You're in. Now help us launch YOUR city."	Referral: "Refer 3 friends to move your city up the launch list" (Share button & link). Data: "Know a business that should be on the map? Add them now" (Form). Gamification: "Join the [City] leaderboard — top referrers get founding member status."	Dynamic city progress bar (e.g., "Charlotte: 847 members. 153 more to launch!").
Business Owner	"We're building demand for you before we even launch."	Data: "Claim your business profile early" (Form). Referral: "Refer other business owners — the more businesses in your city, the sooner we launch there."	Top 5 search terms for their city. Business count: "47 businesses claimed in Charlotte. Be next."
Cultural Ambassador	"Your audience is waiting for this."	Referral: "Share with your followers — every signup from your link counts toward your Ambassador tier" (Link & copy). Data: "Tell us your content niche so Kinfolk AI is ready for you on day one" (Dropdown). Data: "What platforms	"23 ambassadors have joined in Charlotte. Top referrers get early access to Kinfolk AI."

		are you on?" (Checkboxes).	
Safety-Focused	"Your community needs you watching out."	Referral: "Refer friends who should know about this" (Share button). Data: "What's the first thing you'd want an alert about? Help us prioritize." (Checkboxes). Data: "Report a safety concern in your area now" (Form).	"Your reports help protect the community before we even launch."

5. Referral System Mechanics

Every waitlist member receives a unique referral code upon signup, formatted as `MWM-[FIRSTNAME]-[4DIGITS]` . The referral link follows the format `mappingwithmelanin.com/preview?ref=[CODE]` . The system tracks who referred whom, the associated city, and the selected track to manage the tiered reward structure.

Referrals	Reward Tier	Benefits
3	Community Builder	Badge displayed on future profile.
10	City Champion	Badge + priority access at launch.
25	Founding Member	Status + Trailblazer tier free for 1 year.
50+	Ambassador	Invitation to Ambassador program, regardless of initial track.

6. Leaderboards & Dashboards

6.1 City Leaderboard (`/leaderboard`)

A public page ranks all cities by waitlist member count, displaying progress bars toward the launch threshold (e.g., 1,000 for Charlotte), which is adjustable by the founder. Tour stops are highlighted to drive urgency, such as "🔥 Charlotte — Tour stop Aug 15! Help us hit 1,000 by then". The page also features an individual leaderboard per city, showcasing the top referrers.

6.2 Individual Referral Dashboard (/my-referrals?ref=[CODE])

Accessed via the unique referral link without requiring a login, this personalized dashboard displays individual stats, such as referral count, city rank, and progress toward the next tier. It shows the first names of referred users to build a sense of community and includes social share buttons with pre-written copy.

7. Pre-Written Social Copy

To facilitate sharing, users are provided with pre-written copy tailored to their context. General users receive copy highlighting the app's core value: "I just joined @MappingWithMelanin — an app that helps our community find trusted businesses, stay safe, and connect with culture. Join me: [referral link]". City-specific copy drives local urgency: "[City] is [X] members away from launching @MappingWithMelanin. Help us get there: [referral link]". Ambassadors receive specialized copy: "I'm joining @MappingWithMelanin as a Cultural Ambassador. Kinfolk AI matches what my audience needs with minority-owned businesses. Join the waitlist: [referral link]".

8. Technical Requirements (Replit Instructions)

8.1 Database Schema (SQL Migration)

The existing `waitlist` table must be extended with new columns to support the referral system and track-specific data. New tables are required for capturing business suggestions and safety reports.

SQL

```
-- Add new columns to the existing waitlist table
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN referral_code VARCHAR(50) UNIQUE;
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN referred_by VARCHAR(50);
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN referral_count INT DEFAULT 0;
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN track VARCHAR(50);
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN city VARCHAR(100);
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN niche VARCHAR(100); -- For ambassadors
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN platforms TEXT; -- For ambassadors (JSON or com
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN safety_priorities TEXT; -- For safety track
```

```
-- Create new tables for data contributions
CREATE TABLE business_suggestions (
  id SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
  waitlist_id INT REFERENCES waitlist(id),
  business_name VARCHAR(255),
  category VARCHAR(100),
  city VARCHAR(100),
  website VARCHAR(255),
  created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

CREATE TABLE safety_reports (
  id SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
  waitlist_id INT REFERENCES waitlist(id),
  concern_type VARCHAR(100),
  description TEXT,
  city VARCHAR(100),
  created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);
```

8.2 API Endpoint Specifications

The backend requires updates to existing endpoints and the creation of new ones to support the enhanced waitlist experience.

Endpoint	Method	Description	Payload/Parameters
<code>/api/waitlist</code>	POST	Extend existing endpoint to handle new fields. Generates <code>referral_code</code> and increments <code>referral_count</code> for <code>referred_by</code> .	<code>name</code> , <code>email</code> , <code>track</code> , <code>city</code> , <code>referred_by</code>
<code>/api/waitlist/stats</code>	GET	Returns member count, business count, and top referrers for a city.	<code>?city=[city]</code>
<code>/api/waitlist/leaderboard</code>	GET	Returns cities ordered by waitlist count and progress against threshold.	None
<code>/api/waitlist/me</code>	GET	Returns individual referral stats (count,	<code>?ref=[CODE]</code>

		rank, next tier, referred names).	
/api/waitlist/business-suggest	POST	Captures user-submitted business suggestions.	business_name , category , city , website , waitlist_id
/api/waitlist/safety-report	POST	Captures user-submitted safety concerns.	concern_type , description , city , waitlist_id

8.3 Page Descriptions

The frontend requires modifications to the existing /preview page to render track-specific confirmation views after successful form submission. Two new pages must be created: /leaderboard , a public page rendering data from the leaderboard API, and /my-referrals , a personalized dashboard rendering data from the individual stats API.

9. Design & Brand Guidelines

The design must adhere to the established brand identity, utilizing Dark Brown #2B1507 , Gold #CA922B , and Cream #F5F0E8 . Typography relies on Playfair Display for headings and DM Sans for body text. The UI must be mobile-first, optimized for QR code scans at tour stops. Celebratory animations, such as confetti or gold sparkle, should trigger upon signup confirmation. UI components, like progress bars, will use gold fill on a dark brown background, while leaderboards will feature numbered ranks with gold badges.

10. Acceptance Criteria

The implementation is considered complete when the main website homepage includes a prominent "Choose Your Experience" CTA linking to /preview , and users are successfully redirected to a track-specific confirmation view after signup. Unique referral codes must be generated and tracked accurately. The /leaderboard and /my-referrals pages must correctly display their respective data. Furthermore, business suggestions and safety reports must be successfully captured in the database. All new UI components must adhere to the specified brand guidelines.

11. ⚠ DO NOT CHANGE ⚠

The core logic of the waitlist form, specifically the mechanism for capturing Name and Email, must remain intact. Additionally, the existing animated demos on the /preview page

must not be altered or removed.